

⚠️ Action Required: Upgrade Python Environment ⚠️

Python 3.9 is reaching its End-of-Life (EOL) this month. To ensure you have a secure and supported environment for our class practices, **please upgrade to Python 3.10 before tomorrow's class.**

Choose one of the three options below based on your preference.

Here are the three options for you to choose from:

1. **Direct Upgrade: Quickest**, for users who just need the new Python version and are confident in their existing environment.
2. **New Environment: Safest**, for users who want to keep the old setup as a backup, or might have environment-specific dependencies that could break.
3. **Delete and Reinstall: Cleanest**, for users with no need for the old setup and who want to ensure a pristine start.

The commands are identical for both operating systems, Windows and macOS, when using Conda.

Prerequisite: Open Your Terminal/Command Prompt

- **Windows:** Search for and open **Anaconda Prompt**.
 - **macOS:** Open **Terminal** (Applications Utilities Terminal).
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Option 1: Upgrade Python 3.10 directly in coding3 (Recommended for Speed)

This option updates the Python version within your existing coding3 environment.

1. **Activate the Environment:**

```
conda activate coding3
```

2. **Update Python to 3.10:**

```
conda install python=3.10
```

- Conda will list the packages it needs to install/update/downgrade to accommodate Python 3.10. Type y and press **Enter** to proceed.

3. **Verify the Upgrade:**

```
python --version
```

- The output should show Python 3.10.x.

Option 2: Create a New Environment coding3v2 (Recommended for Safety)

This is the safest option, as it leaves your old coding3 environment untouched.

1. Create the New Environment with Python 3.10:

```
conda create --name coding3v2 python=3.10
```

- Type y and press **Enter** when prompted.

2. Activate the New Environment:

```
conda activate coding3v2
```

3. Install Necessary Packages:

- Since you have created a new environment, you will need to reinstall any packages we previously installed:

```
conda install -c conda-forge opencv numpy jupyter ipykernel
```

- **Example:** If you used numpy and pandas:

```
conda install -c conda-forge opencv numpy jupyter ipykernel
```

4. Verify the Installation:

```
python --version
```

- The output should show Python 3.10.x.

Option 3: Delete coding3 and Reinstall (Recommended for a Clean Slate)

This is the cleanest option, but it **permanently deletes** your coding3 environment and all installed packages.

1. **Deactivate the Environment** (if currently active):

```
conda deactivate
```

2. **Remove the Old Environment:**

```
conda env remove --name coding3
```

- Type y and press **Enter** when prompted.

3. **Create the New Environment with Python 3.10:**

```
conda create --name coding3 python=3.10
```

4. **Activate the New Environment:**

```
conda activate coding3
```

5. **Install Necessary Packages:**

- You must now reinstall all your required packages (e.g., numpy, pandas, etc.):

```
conda install -c conda-forge opencv numpy jupyter ipykernel
```

6. **Verify the Installation:**

```
python --version
```

- The output should show Python 3.10.x.